

Public Misled
On Air Quality
Following 9/11

Coming to Light on Eve
of 25th Anniversary

By SALLY GOLDENBERG
and NINA AGRAWAL

In the harrowing months that followed the attacks on the World Trade Center, New Yorkers were repeatedly assured that the air around the fallen towers was safe to breathe.

But 10 months later, health officials were still finding evidence of asbestos as much as half a mile away, according to a sample of air quality records released on Tuesday.

The documents, reviewed by The New York Times in advance of their release, include more than 170,000 pages of air quality reports, contamination records and correspondence among city officials. The records were stored in 68 boxes in a city office, shielded from public view for more than two decades and, according to city officials, discovered only last year.

Mayor Zohran Mamdani directed his administration to release the records to the public through an online portal, timing it to the commemoration of the 25th anniversary of the attacks in Lower Manhattan.

Over the course of the next year, his administration intends to review, redact and publicize many more papers, found in municipal and insurance offices, that relate to the environmental toxic materials brought about by Sept. 11.

The records released on Tuesday provide a snapshot of the frenzied months after the attacks, when New York City and its leaders were struggling to balance the city’s recovery with fears of terrorism and lingering toxic substances.

The documents are limited in scope, offering only a fraction of the air quality reports taken around ground zero. And while they also include a smattering of internal memos — including the so-called Harding memo, in which the city discussed its potential liability stemming from the Sept. 11 air quality — many more are presumably absent.

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TING-LI WANG/THE NEW YORK TIMES

The aftermath of the fall of 7 World Trade Center on Sept. 11.



CARLOS OSORIO/REUTERS

Driving between Windsor, Ontario, and Detroit. On Tuesday, Canada began enforcing tariffs up to 50 percent on many U.S. goods.

Allies of Israel
Are Penalizing
Its Settlements

This article is by Stephen Castle, Adam Rasgon, Aaron Boxerman and Isabel Kershner.

LONDON — Britain, Canada and France on Tuesday announced sanctions on Israeli settlements in the occupied West Bank, a symbolic step by three once-staunch allies illustrating Israel’s deepening isolation after the devastating war in Gaza and settler violence in the West Bank.

Israel has been increasingly ostracized over its conduct of the war in Gaza, in which tens of thousands of Palestinians have been killed. International attention is now focused on its tightening grip on the West Bank and its expansion of illegal settlements there. In recent weeks, Israeli extremist settlers have repeatedly attacked Palestinians as the military has stood by.

Israel responded to Britain’s announcement with fury and indignation and announced countermeasures. Israel said it would close the British Consulate General in East Jerusalem. The institution, founded in 1839, represents the British government in Jerusalem, the occupied West Bank and Gaza.

The coordinated move by the three nations risks further sour-

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Navy Accused of Ignoring Pilots’ Brain Injuries

By DAVE PHILLIPPS

As concerns mounted that the extreme physical strain of flying fighter jets was causing brain injuries in pilots, and may have led to the death of a number of career aviators, the Navy did almost nothing.

It didn’t even study its pilots to understand if it had a problem.

That is one of the numerous findings in a harshly critical report released on Tuesday by the powerful House Oversight Committee. The report said that because the Navy had repeatedly failed to act, Congress should pass legislation requiring the military to create a specific program to study and care for the brain health of all aviators.

“Despite credible warnings, external reporting and internal awareness, the Navy has yet to

Caught Up in Catch-22
Over Evidence That
It Never Gathered

determine whether the very conditions that define naval aviation may also be causing long-term harm to the pilots who endure them,” the report said. “Instead, it has relied on a system designed to respond to visible injuries, while leaving potential cumulative damage largely unexamined.”

Naval aviators are repeatedly exposed to body-crushing forces as they catapult off aircraft carriers and pull high G-force turns in training. The Navy has never studied how those forces over time affect the human brain, which contains 100 billion neurons

in a network with a consistency similar to Jell-O.

A number of career pilots have raised concerns that those repeated exposures may cause brain injuries that slowly accrue over years of service and lead to debilitating mental health problems.

“Landing on a carrier is like a car crash. In my career I’ve been in hundreds of car crashes,” said Matthew Buckley, a former TOPGUN pilot who after 15 years of flying struggled with headaches, mood swings and suicidal thoughts. He later started an organization to help the many other pilots he encountered who were experiencing similar problems.

“I’m almost shaking, I’m so furious,” he said after learning about the findings of the House committee. “People have died. We know

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KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

A House report found no evidence that the Navy considered its jets to be one of the root causes.

Before Being Senator, a Doctor
Sued Hundreds of His Patients

By SARAH KLIFF

It was Easter weekend in 2007 when a police car pulled up to Joe Vasquez’s home in rural Kansas.

A doctor had filed a lawsuit against him and his wife over an unpaid \$4,561 bill from her emergency hysterectomy three years earlier. They had missed a court date, and the doctor’s lawyers asked the court to issue an arrest warrant. The police took the couple into custody as their grandchildren prepared for an egg hunt, Mr. Vasquez said. They spent two days in jail before their son could borrow the money to post bond.

“We had no money to pay,” said Mr. Vasquez, now 68. At the time, his wife was working at a manufacturing plant and he was on disability, he said.

The doctor who sued the couple was Roger Marshall, now a senator from Kansas. Mr. Marshall, a Republican who is seeking reelection this fall, filed lawsuits against more than 700 patients with outstanding bills during his decades-long career as an obstetrician-gynecologist, according to a New York Times analysis of Kansas court records.

Patients were arrested in 81 of those cases for missing court dates, the records show. In an additional 13 lawsuits, Mr. Marshall’s lawyers sought warrants but it is unclear whether an arrest occurred. They also garnished patients’ paychecks and bank accounts. They routinely charged

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Funding at Risk, a School District Sues Over an Anti-Trans Push

By MICHAEL C. BENDER

GOLDEN, Colo. — Rob Stein had been interim school superintendent in Jefferson County, Colo., for 22 days when he sued the Trump administration this summer over demands to change the district’s transgender-inclusive policies.

Dr. Stein and other district officials say they had no choice. The cash-strapped district, Jeffco Pub-

lic Schools, risked losing all \$50 million of its federal funding for school meals and special education if they refused. But if they acquiesced, they concluded, they would violate state laws that protect transgender students from discrimination.

“This has been just an enormous distraction,” Dr. Stein said in an interview from the district’s foothill-framed headquarters. “It has added a lot of stress to the sys-

Squeezed by State Law
and a Trump Threat

tem and to the kids who are being targeted here.”

What the district cast as a practical decision is viewed as a rare counterstrike from public schools, universities and hospitals in support of a transgender rights move-

THE WEATHER

Today, partly cloudy, more humid, high 85. Tonight, clouds early, a shower late, low 71. Tomorrow, humid, mostly cloudy, a thunderstorm, high 84. Weather map, Page B12.

CANADA IMPOSES
ARRAY OF TARIFFS;
TRUMP HITS BACK

A WIDENING TRADE WAR

President Seeks to Limit
Federal Purchases of
U.S. Ally’s Goods

By TONY ROMM

WASHINGTON — New Canadian tariffs targeting roughly \$20 billion in U.S. imports snapped into place on Tuesday, prompting President Trump to retaliate hours later by trying to limit the federal government’s ability to buy Canadian goods.

The president’s move, conveyed in a social media post, escalated a widening trade war between the two longtime allies, a conflict that may yet unleash serious financial blowback for consumers and businesses on both sides of the border.

The latest front began after midnight, when Canada began enforcing tariffs up to 50 percent on a variety of U.S. goods, including clothing, cheese, metal parts and wood products. The approach was meant to mimic the taxes that Mr. Trump imposed on Canada last month, after trade talks between the two neighbors collapsed in acrimony.

In response, Mr. Trump said Tuesday that he had directed his administration to take steps to “REMOVE Canadian-origin products” from a key government procurement system that guides federal purchasing.

Mr. Trump said he was acting reciprocally, claiming that Canada had “banned American Small Businesses and Companies from selling into their Government Procurement Markets.” He said the policy would remain in place “unless Canada restores full and fair reciprocity for American Farmers and Companies.”

The White House did not immediately comment on Mr. Trump’s plan.

For now, the economic effects of the tit-for-tat may be limited because it implicates only a small portion of the annual trade between the United States and Canada. The more pressing concern is a potential cycle of retaliation, one that results in even higher and more exhaustive duties that drive apart the two intertwined economies.

In Canada, Prime Minister Mark Carney has sought to position himself as a bulwark against Mr. Trump’s trade aggression, describing his nation as “at war.” Canadian officials generally have pledged to respond “dollar for dollar” to any U.S. duties.

In Washington, the president and his aides have repeatedly mocked their Canadian counterparts and the size of their ally’s economy and military. Mr. Trump has matched the tough talk with a threat to impose duties on Canada’s auto industry while promising to block Bombardier, a plane

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NECESSARY MOVE In a video address, Prime Minister Mark Carney said Canada’s response was unavoidable. PAGE A6



BUSINESS B1-5

Stocks Unfazed Amid Chaos

Investors are looking past global crises to focus on strong corporate earnings and A.I. promises.

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A Big Change to the iPhone

Fans of Apple’s products widely believe it will unveil a folding smartphone at its annual launch event.

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INTERNATIONAL A4-10

China’s Dire Job Market

A record 12.7 million young people are looking for work as the country’s embrace of artificial intelligence begins to eliminate entry-level positions.

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New Test for German Leader

A blowout win by a far-right party in a state election has put pressure on the chancellor. News Analysis.

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SPORTS B6-9

Introducing QB Index

A writer has a new spin on an N.F.L. statistic that ranks the relative merits of the man in the pocket.

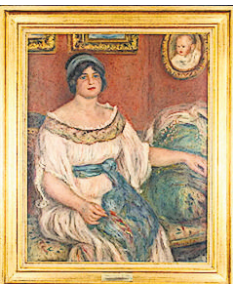
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ARTS C1-6

A Raid
On Renoirs

Almost a year after a Louvre heist, thieves took a portrait of Colonna Romano, right, and another painting by the artist at a museum that was once his home.

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Dance Center’s New Chapter

A year after a longtime staff member was killed in an accident at Jacob’s Pillow in western Massachusetts, the recovery continues.

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NATIONAL A11-17, 20

Smithsonian’s Leader to Leave

In the face of escalating White House attacks about how museums present American history, Lonnie G. Bunch III, 73, announced his decision to resign after seven years as secretary.

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Missouri Denied Again on Map

Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh upheld a state Supreme Court ruling that blocked the use of a new congressional voting map that favors Republicans without a state referendum.

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OPINION A18-19

Erika Kirk

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FOOD D1-8

For the Tastiest Tailgates

We have recipes for sliders, wings, chili and other dishes that are perfect for a stadium parking lot, or even for football fans watching from the couch.

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